

Changing emotions

For some teens, puberty brings new emotions that can be difficult to express. Many teens may be overly sensitive or irritable, or may feel angry, self-conscious, or insecure. These feelings are completely normal, but for the teen, they can sometimes seem overwhelming. Talking openly about new emotions with a friend or parent can help tweens and teens understand and reflect upon how they are feeling.



△ Mood swings

A teen's mood can often swing up and down abruptly. Teens might feel grumpy one minute and be laughing the next.



△ Romantic feelings

During puberty, teens may start to feel attracted to other people. This can be exciting, but also a bit confusing.



First period

Menstruation is probably the biggest change a young woman experiences during puberty.



Sweat and smells

During the teen years, the body starts to produce more sweat, which can cause body odor and smelly feet.



Pimples

Pimples are a common teenage complaint, caused by clogged pores and trapped bacteria.



Armpit hair

Under the arms, the hair gets darker, longer, and thicker.



Wider hips

The hips widen in preparation for giving birth at some point in the future.

